view that the need was for setting up a large number of banks in rural areas to mobilize rural savings and to cater to the diverse financial needs of the rural community who needed help the most but rarely got it. Realizing that the prosperity of a predominantly agrarian economy lay in the rural areas, he wanted Indian banks to promote subsidiaries such as district joint-stock banks.

Sorabji's view on the expanding role of a banker is best expressed in his own words: 'Our bank is imbued with the spirit of continual alertness which seeks to manifest itself in the inauguration of fresh schemes of national service…Till a few years ago the banker's conception of his duty to the public was restricted to very narrow limits, and they were satisfied if they did the ordinary banking business of receiving deposits and cashing cheques. Latterly, however things have changed and the banker is looked upon as a friend, philosopher, and guide in matters financial. He is today expected to discharge many functions which according to the strictly orthodox school would be outside the range of banking proper, and I think I can attest that our Bank was amongst the earliest in this country to realize the inevitability of this tendency.'[18] Prescient words indeed and all the more remarkable for having been uttered more than seven decades ago. Clearly, Sorabji was a man who saw tomorrow. At a time when other banks focused on financing trade, the Central Bank broke new ground by lending to small enterprises. It disbursed small loans to provide seed capital to companies. One such company which became one of the largest in its field was Lupin Laboratories to which the bank had given a loan of ₹30,000.

Many of Sorabji's precepts have become the received wisdom of the day; and Sorabji's career and that of his bank were a contemporary endorsement of these precepts. The Indian Banks' Association, though formed in 1946, nearly a decade after Sorabji's demise, owed much to his insistence to have a common forum for Directors and executives of Indian banks to exchange ideas, formulate policies, and regulate behaviour. In fact, it was Sorabji who had spelt out clearly the role of a bank and the criteria for distinguishing a bank[19] from a non-banking institution, something which found its way into the Banking Companies Act of 1949.